

Drinking Water Quality, Testing and BIS Certification · Reference Guide (Sample)

1. SCOPE OF THIS GUIDE

This guide explains, for consumers and small businesses, how Indian Standards relate to packaged drinking water, packaged natural mineral water and the testing of water quality. It is a training aid and not an official BIS document. Always verify current requirements on the official BIS source.

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2. PACKAGED DRINKING WATER vs NATURAL MINERAL WATER

Packaged drinking water is treated water from any source, packed for sale, and is covered by IS 14543 (Packaged Drinking Water, Other than Packaged Natural Mineral Water). Packaged natural mineral water is water from a protected underground source and is covered by IS 13428 (Packaged Natural Mineral Water). The two are different products with different standards: mineral water must not be treated to alter its essential mineral character, while packaged drinking water may be treated by filtration, reverse osmosis, disinfection and similar processes. Both products have been under mandatory BIS certification through Quality Control Orders. Verify the latest status on the official BIS source.

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3. BIS CERTIFICATION AND MARKING

Under the certification scheme the manufacturer operates under a BIS licence and the bottles or packs carry the ISI mark together with the licence number (CM/L), the IS standard number, batch identification and the manufacturing date. Consumers should check the ISI mark, the licence number, the type of water declared on the label (packaged drinking water or natural mineral water) and the best-before date before purchase. Product sold without the required mark should not be accepted.

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4. WATER QUALITY REQUIREMENTS AND TESTING

Water quality is assessed for physical, chemical and microbiological parameters. Test methods for water and wastewater are covered by the IS 3025 series (Methods of Sampling and Test, Physical and Chemical), which is used part by part for parameters such as pH, turbidity, total dissolved solids and residual chlorine. Microbiological requirements (for example absence of coliform bacteria and faecal streptococci) form part of the packaged water standards. Sampling procedures for water analysis are described in IS 3025 Part 1. Drinking-water acceptability criteria for public supplies are specified in IS 10500 (Drinking Water).

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5. LABORATORY TESTING AND CONSUMER TIPS

Water testing should be done by laboratories that follow the relevant IS 3025 test methods. For packaged water, consumers cannot test at home: rely on the BIS mark, intact seals, clear labelling and purchase before the best-before date. For borewell or municipal supply, a laboratory test report should state the parameter, the result, the unit, the method used (IS 3025 part) and the acceptable limit referenced. If a packaged water product does not carry the required BIS mark, consumers may report it through the official BIS complaint channels.